



Search and replace text in Vim

Shown below is the basic fundamental usage of the text substitution inside the Vim editor. When you want a specific text (search) to be replaced with another text in the entire file, then you can use the following sequence.

- 1) Replace with confirmation:

```
:%s/search/replace/gc
```

- 2) Without confirmation:

```
:%s/search/replace/g
```

- 3) Replace only in the lines 1 – 10

```
:1,10s/search/replace/g
```



Ways to use the powerful tar command

In Linux, *tar* is a very powerful command for archiving files and folders. Here are a few ways in which it can be used.

- 1) Creating an archive using the *tar* command:

```
# tar cvf archiveName.tar dirname/
```

- 2) Creating a *tar* gzipped archive using the option *cvzf*:

```
#tar cvzf archiveName.tar.gz dirname/
```

- 3) Creating a bzipipped *tar* archive using the option *cvfj*:

```
#tar cvfj archiveName.tar.bz2 dirname/
```

- 4) Extracting (untar) an archive using the *tar* command:

```
#tar xvf archiveName.tar
```

- 5) Extracting a gzipped *tar* archive (*.tar.gz) using the option *xvzf*:

```
#tar xvzf archiveName.tar.gz
```

- 6) Extracting a bzipipped *tar* archive (*.tar.bz2) using the option *xvfj*:

```
#tar xvfj archiveName.tar.bz2
```

Given below are the details for the switch used in the above commands

- c – create a new archive
- v – verbosely list files that are processed
- f – the following is the archive file name
- z – create a gzip archive
- j – create a bzip2 archive
- x – extract files from archive

—Anil K.P, meanilkp@gmail.com



Clearing a recently accessed file list from the command line

GNU/Linux stores a list of recently accessed files in the *.local/share/recently-used.xbel* file in XML format. This file is located under the user's home directory. A graphical file manager also uses this file to display 'Recent Files' entries.

To clear a recently accessed file list, just truncate the contents of *.local/share/recently-used.xbel* file:

```
[bash]$ > ~/.local/share/recently-used.xbel
```

—Narendra Kangralkar,
narendrakangralkar@gmail.com



Inserting another file's contents to the current file with Vim editor

Here is an easy way to insert another file's contents to the current file using Vim editor. Open a file using the following command:

```
# vi myfile.txt
```

In the opened file, run the following command:

```
:r myanotherfile.txt
```